MARTHA: (*raising her head*) Who is it?

JOHN: I can't see (*with sudden **apprehension***) It looks like Mr. Marshall.

BALDWIN: Mr. Marshall? (*The doorbell rings. He goes to a window commanding a view of the doorway.*) It is Mr. Marshall.

BALDWIN: It is Marshall.

MARTHA: The President of the Third National?

BALDWIN: Yes. What does he want here?

EVIE: Shall I show him in, Father?

BALDWIN: Yes, yes, by all means.

(*Evie goes out.*)

Let's understand better:

Mr. Marshall informs Baldwin that Gresham had admitted his guilt, as he knew that Baldwin, being an honest and upright man, would never give false testimony.

MARTHA: (*crossing to him quickly*) Robert! Be careful of what you say; you're to go on the stand tomorrow.

BALDWIN: (*nervously*) Yes, yes, I'll look out.

(*Evie re-enters, opening the door for Marshall.*)

MARSHALL: (*coming into the room very **buoyantly***) Well, well, spending the afternoon indoors? How are you, Mrs. Baldwin? (*He shakes hands cordially*) And you, Baldwin?

MARTHA: We were just going out. Come, Evie.

MARSHALL: Oh, you needn't go on my account. You can hear what I have to say. (*He turns to the head of the family*) Baldwin, if you feel like coming around to the Third National sometime this week, you'll find a position waiting for you.

BALDWIN: (*thunderstruck*) Do you mean that, Mr. Marshall?

MARSHALL: (*smiling*) I wouldn't say it if I didn't. (*He continues more seriously.*) I was in to see Gresham this afternoon. He told me about the offer he had made you. But he knew that no amount of money would make you do something you thought wrong. Baldwin, he paid you the supreme compliment; rather than go to trial with you to testify against him, he confessed.

BALDWIN: (*sinking into a chair*) Confessed!

MARSHALL: Told the whole story. (*He turns to Martha*) I can only say to you what every man will be saying tomorrow: how highly I honour and respect your husband! How sincerely-

Let's understand better:

Mr. Marshall offers Baldwin a job at his bank, The Third International, thus rewarding him for his uprightness.

MARTHA: (*seizing his hand **piteously***) Please! Please! Can't you see he's crying?

(Slowly, the curtain falls.)

- (slightly adapted)

12th General_English_Unit_3_C_Supplementary.indd 105 07-12-2021 18:05:32